

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, dry, partly cloudy, high 83. Tonight, dry, mostly cloudy, gentle wind, low 65. Tomorrow, cloudy with periodic rain and thunderstorms, high 73. Weather map, Page 20.

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Prices in Canada may be higher

\$6.00



Andre Shelton, in the blue jersey, played with friends in a garage at the American Dream mall in East Rutherford, N.J., this month.

VINCENT ALBAN FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

STRAIT IS CLOSED, IRAN ANNOUNCES

Claim Disputed by U.S. — Talks Are Still On

This article is by **Abdi Latif Dahir**, **Zolan Kanno-Youngs** and **Alan Yuhas**.

BEIRUT, Lebanon — The status of the Strait of Hormuz was thrown into confusion Saturday after Iran’s military said that it again closed the waterway to maritime traffic, accusing the United States and Israel of reneging on the deal to open it. The U.S. military, however, said ships were still passing through the strait.

Reopening the strait, a vital passageway for oil and other goods into and out of the Middle East, was a primary accomplishment of the deal signed by President Trump and President Masoud Pezeshkian of Iran last week. That deal effectively ceased fighting between the two countries for now and set the stage for more detailed negotiations on the future of Iran’s nuclear program.

Even as they argued over the renewed Iranian threats to shipping, both countries appeared reluctant on Saturday to scuttle the agreement or derail the negotiations.

Vice President JD Vance left for Switzerland to hold talks there on Sunday with an Iranian negotiating team. Mr. Trump’s envoys, Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner, were already there. A spokesman for Iran’s foreign ministry said that an Iranian delegation was on its way.

“I think we’re going to hopefully make progress on the nuclear issue, make progress on the Lebanon cease-fire issue,” Mr. Vance

Continued on Page 12

For These World Cup Fans, the Party’s Inside

By **ANDREW KEH**

EAST RUTHERFORD, N.J. — Benjamin Klevge, a soccer fan from Pamiers, France, had the front-facing camera open on his phone and a wide smile on his face. He crouched down, struggling to fit the Statue of Liberty into the frame.

It wasn’t the actual Statue of Liberty, though. It was a 60-foot replica, encrusted with more than a million green jelly beans, towering above the entrance to a three-story candy store.

And Mr. Klevge wasn’t in New York. He wasn’t even outdoors. He

New Jersey Megamall Replaces Tailgating

was roaming the gaping halls of American Dream, a three-million-square-foot megamall in East Rutherford, N.J. He took more pictures in front of an indoor water park a few steps away as a Backstreet Boys song from the previous century played over the loudspeakers.

“C’est magnifique,” he said, before switching to English. “It’s beautiful.”

Fans who attended the opening match of this World Cup earlier this month in Mexico City could wander a warren of neighborhood streets alive with music and the smell of grilled meat on their way to Estadio Azteca.

Other citadels of soccer — whether Maracanã Stadium in Rio de Janeiro, which hosted the 1950 and 2014 finals, or Santiago Bernabéu in Madrid, where the final was played in 1982 — are similarly embedded in dense, urban landscapes, helping to animate the heartbeats of their respective cities.

Continued on Page 26



MARIAN CARRASQUERO FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Using Mexican Laws to Intimidate Journalists

Élfego Riveros’s satirical radio spot led to a conviction for gender-based political violence. Page 4.

Thanks to A.I., Student Cheating With A.I. Is Harder to Detect

By **DANA GOLDSTEIN**

The videos are all over social media, making students an irresistible offer: Go ahead and let A.I. do your homework — with the latest technology, you won’t get caught.

If you hate writing, you can avoid it.

Even established ed-tech companies are marketing with a wink and a nod.

These kinds of tutorials are now pervasive on TikTok and YouTube. They show students how to use tools known as humanizers and autotypers, which make it easier than ever to cheat. The videos — sometimes labeled ads, sometimes not — target college and high school students.

Humanizers rewrite A.I.-produced text to make it sound less robotic, formulaic and trite.

Autotypers slowly drip words

and sentences into documents, making it appear as if papers were typed at a human pace when in fact, they were produced by A.I. They even fabricate typos, deletions and revisions.

Both can help students evade software designed to detect A.I.

Colleges and K-12 schools are trying to keep up, with A.I. detection becoming a significant expense. But educators attempting to restrict the technology, worried

about students failing to develop basic skills, are often lagging in what tech-industry leaders are calling a detection arms race.

In some cases, the same companies selling detection tools are also making apps that allow students to cheat, including by writing papers for them or rephrasing text written by others. The apps promise to help them avoid accusations of misconduct by scanning

Continued on Page 16

How Hegseth Is Waging A War Against Diversity

Blocking of Promotion for a Black Admiral Illustrates the Use of Secret Vetting

By **GREG JAFFE** and **KATE KELLY**

WASHINGTON — The Navy’s top leadership believed that Rear Adm. Stephen D. Barnett was by far the best choice to lead the command that oversees the Navy’s bases at home and abroad.

He had more experience than the other candidates and had successfully managed the aftermath of one of the Navy’s biggest messes, a fuel spill that contaminated an aquifer on a base in Hawaii, sickening thousands.

The final decision this spring fell to Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth.

To many in the Navy, Admiral Barnett’s promotion seemed like a foregone conclusion.

The officer, however, had a big strike against him. Like other Black military leaders, he had been encouraged by his superiors to help the Navy recruit and retain minority officers, who remain significantly underrepresented in the force. His years-old remarks on the importance of diversity had been flagged in a secret vetting process designed to weed out senior leaders whom Mr. Hegseth and his team pegged as a problem.

Instead of Admiral Barnett, Mr. Hegseth selected a white officer who was the Navy leadership’s third choice.

So far this year, Mr. Hegseth has blocked the promotions of at least 40 senior officers to general and admiral ranks. About half of those are women or members of minority groups.

This article, based on interviews with 15 current and former military and administration officials, is a look inside the process Mr. Hegseth and his team have used to halt the advancement of senior officers for reasons that have nothing to do with fighting wars or job performance.

It tells the story of one Black officer — Admiral Barnett — whose blocked promotion shocked and angered senior Navy officials.

The officials discussed sensitive personnel matters on the condition of anonymity. Admiral Barnett, who is expected to retire, declined a request for comment. A Pentagon spokesman did not respond to a detailed list of questions. In books and speeches, Mr.

Hegseth has maintained that the Pentagon’s push over the past decade to build a more diverse force had elevated women and minority officers to senior jobs that they had not earned.

“When I think about my career in uniform, in almost every instance where there has been poor leadership or people in positions they’re not qualified for, it was based on either the reality or the perception of a ‘diversity hire,’” Mr. Hegseth, a former major in the Army National Guard, wrote in his 2024 book “The War on Warriors.”

As defense secretary, he has promised to install a new promotion system that will be “ruthlessly meritocratic” and “focused squarely” on “warfighting ability.”

In practice, though, his approach has made it harder for



Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth chose a white officer over Rear Adm. Stephen D. Barnett, angering officials.

Black and female officers to get promoted to senior ranks, even when their records are exemplary.

Such was the case with Admiral Barnett. In 2021, he was invited to speak at a Black History Month event at a naval base in Maryland.

He talked about his career as a flight officer on Navy P-3 Orions, which track enemy submarines. “Just one generation before me, it was nearly unthinkable for a Black person to become a naval aviator,” he said.

He reflected on his mentors, downplaying the importance of race. “What helped me was people who didn’t look like me,” he said.

And he spoke about building a force that better represented the nation it serves.

“As the country becomes more diverse, it makes sense for our

Continued on Page 19

Gunfire at a ‘No Kings’ March Was Deadly. Was It a Crime?

By **KURT STREETER**

SALT LAKE CITY — Afa Ah Loo was filming the crowd at a No Kings march in downtown Salt Lake City. About 10,000 people had come, part of a national movement protesting the Trump presidency. It was one of the largest demonstrations the city had seen.

A woman dressed as Lady Liberty entered the frame of his cellphone video. Michelle Van Tassell, one of the protesters, had made the costume in her sewing room: a foam crown, a green robe, a torch shaped from household items.

It was the evening of June 14, 2025. Walking near the middle of State Street, Mr. Ah Loo panned across the marchers, the wide brim of his tan hat low against the evening sun. In his other hand he carried a sign: white cardboard, four words in large black letters. “The world is watching.”

Gunfire split the air. Three shots. Pop. Pop. Pop.

The crowd broke. Ms. Van Tassell walked toward the man on the ground, Mr. Ah Loo. A tan hat lay near him on the asphalt. She came close enough to see the bullet wound in his temple. She raised her torch and said, to no one in particular, “This is not who we are.”



KIM RAFF FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

A stray bullet killed Afa Ah Loo at a march last year.

The shooter, a contractor named Matthew Alder, had volunteered to help keep the marchers safe. He would later say he had shot at an armed man he believed was about to open fire on the crowd. Mr. Alder said he had no intention of hitting Mr. Ah Loo.

More than 1,500 demonstrations took place across the country that day, the largest single day of protest in the United States in years. Nearly all were peaceful.

Continued on Page 17

NATIONAL 14-24

Ways to Get Dad to Open Up

Fathers tend to be more willing to give advice than to talk about themselves. These questions can be starting points for deeper conversations. PAGE 14

Witness to a Deadly Crash

A skydiver wasn’t sure she could keep doing the activity she loved after seeing an aircraft go down in Missouri. PAGE 16

METROPOLITAN

Free to Park, but Few Spots

In a city with a tiny percentage of paid meters, drivers fight for scant spaces. Can the system be fixed? PAGE 6



REAL ESTATE

Take a Seat and Explore

Striking chairs and benches are a vital part of Madoo, a garden in Sagaponack, N.Y. PAGE 7

SUNDAY STYLES

Judged by Their Covers

Portraits and images that were taken by the photographer Wolfgang Tillmans have been helping to turn some books into best-sellers. PAGE 1

It All Seems So Gloppy

Advertisers and product makers have latched onto a gooey type of text to catch the eyes of consumers. PAGE 4

OBITUARIES 29-31

Master of the TV Sitcom

James Burrows, 85, helped create “Cheers” and directed “Taxi,” “Friends” and “The Big Bang Theory.” PAGE 29



ARTS & LEISURE

Maya Rudolph? ‘Oh, Mary!’

For her Broadway debut, the comedian says that when she needed it most, she was saved by improv. PAGE 4

Dad Movies for the Ages

Why do certain films appeal to fathers? We pondered, then made a list of titles that’s sure to please. PAGE 10

SUNDAY BUSINESS

One Man Is Tied to 3 Scandals

Shane Hennen, a professional gambler, faces charges in the N.B.A., N.C.A.A. and poker gambling cases. PAGE 6

Beneficiaries of Remote Work

A postpandemic openness to accommodating families has helped more parents balance jobs and child care. PAGE 1

SUNDAY OPINION

Binyamin Appelbaum

PAGE 12

